

SUPERVISION, SUPPORT AND PARTICIPANT AUTONOMY

1. Job Coaches will provide supervision and support to their clients in community settings during day program service hours. Supervision means that you can see them and get to them quickly to offer support (instruction and/or assistance) and/or keep them safe.
2. Clients will be supported to be as independent as possible, in their handling of their personal needs, in their day-to-day decision making, and in the activities of community living. They will be encouraged to develop agency (the feeling of control over their own actions and their consequences) and self-determination (providing direction over their own lives).
3. Clients may briefly leave the Job Coach's visual line of sight, to use the restroom, explore a store aisle, work in a different area of a jobsite, or make a purchase on their own. Each client's Individual Service Plan offers guidelines on how much autonomy they can safely handle. Some capable individuals can handle doing many things unsupervised; others must be kept by your side as much as possible. Clients will be instructed to discuss with their Job Coach where they will be, how long they will be "out of sight", and when and where they will rejoin the group. This is similar to the courtesy of friends who are visiting a setting together, who chose to separate and then rejoin each other. Clients will be thanked for informing the Job Coach of their plans and congratulated for following through on what they said they would do.
4. Job Coaches agree that they are "on duty" during lunch and two 10-minute rest periods, and are paid for that period of time. Job Coaches are encouraged to rest, eat and use the restroom whenever participants do so. Sharing breaks, snack and meal times, is conducive to conversation and social support. Working on client Data Packets can be accomplished when clients are relaxing in a safe setting (like a library) and can be monitored while the Job Coach makes their notes.
5. Clients may not be left in a parked car while the Job Coach enters a building. The exception may be at pick-ups/drop-offs, when a participant may be safer staying seated for several minutes while the Job Coach escorts other participants to/from the car. Lower several car windows during warm weather to ensure adequate ventilation is maintained in the cabin when the engine is off. Never leave your car keys in the ignition, or leave the car without the parking brake on while a client sits in your parked car.
6. Job Coaches will provide privacy to participants using a public restroom, but be nearby to offer support. They can be either inside the restroom, or standing outside by the door. Job Coaches should make themselves aware of who else is inside the restroom. Whenever possible, encourage the client to wait until community members (especially children) have finished using the restroom before going in themselves. If the Job Coach must use the restroom while clients wait, the Job Coach should ensure that they are seated comfortably nearby, with directions to remain seated and wait for the Job Coach's return. Individuals who are at high risk of wandering off, elopement or bothering others will be asked to wait inside the restroom with the Job Coach.
7. Job Coaches are encouraged to program alongside another Coach as a means of providing additional supervision and support to their clients. Such pairing up must be approved by the Program Administrator, considering if the abilities and needs of all clients involved are similar enough so that they all may take part in the same activities and may or may not last all program day depending upon the Program Administrator's recommendations.
8. Job Coaches will discuss with the Program Administrator any concerns they have regarding supervision issues, including client requests for more autonomy or difficulty maintaining line-of-sight supervision of clients while in the community.